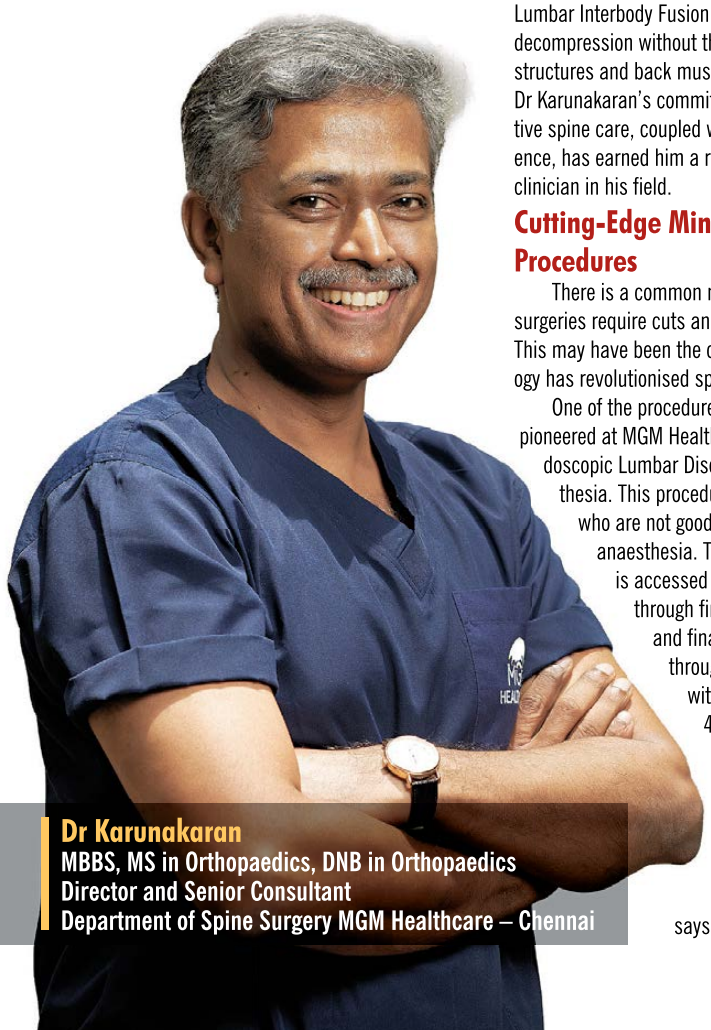
MGM HEALTHCARE

MGM Healthcare's Advanced Spine Speciality (MASS) is a state-of-the-art facility which takes a step-by-step approach to treating spinal problems. Using the latest diagnostic tools–like advanced imaging and 3D printing of the spine–it is able to provide the most effective treatment. The Department is a pioneer in minimally invasive spine surgery.

Modern sedentary lifestyles come with a host of spinal issues. One of the most common is disc prolapse, or slipped disc, which can present either as back pain or a radiating pain called sciatica. In adverse situations it can cause bowel and bladder disturbance, known as Cauda Equina Syndrome. Disc-related pain can be treated initially with posture correction, stretches, strengthening exercises, and medication. Very few patients require further intervention and then also, thanks to advances in technology, the treatment can be largely non-invasive at leading facilities like MGM Healthcare's Department of Spine Surgery.



Dr Karunakaran
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Dr S. Karunakaran is a highly esteemed spine surgeon at the Department with over 25 years of experience. A pioneer in minimally invasive spine surgery, his areas of expertise include Sutureless Percutaneous Endoscopic Day Care Spine Surgery, Evaluation of pain generators with Discography Facet, Selective nerve root and transforaminal injections, PRP Autologous Conditioned Serum injections, Minimally Invasive Fusion Techniques for the Spine, Posterior Lumbar Interbody Fusion Surgery (PLIF), Anterior Lumbar Interbody Fusion (ALIF), Oblique Lumbar Interbody Fusion (OLIF) providing indirect decompression without the need for handling neural structures and back muscles and Scoliosis Surgery. Dr Karunakaran's commitment to providing preventive spine care, coupled with his extensive experience, has earned him a reputation as a distinguished clinician in his field.

Cutting-Edge Minimally Invasive Procedures

There is a common misconception that spinal surgeries require cuts and can cause nerve injury. This may have been the case in the past, but technology has revolutionised spine surgery in recent times.

One of the procedures Dr Karunakaran has pioneered at MGM Healthcare is Percutaneous Endoscopic Lumbar Discectomy under local anaesthesia. This procedure is suitable for patients who are not good candidates for general anaesthesia. The relevant disc fragment is accessed through an 8-10mm hole through first a needle, then a dilator and finally an endoscope. "We go through the natural existing space without making cuts and use 4K monitors and HD cameras which help us visualise the structure really well. Also, the procedure is done under continuous saline irrigation which helps greatly with clarity," says Dr Karunakaran. It's a day procedure or at most requires an overnight stay.

Dr Karunakaran recalls a couple of cases where the Department of Spine Surgery was able to provide a safe and effective solution for a complex issue. "A 65-year-old female with excruciating pain could not go for a procedure in multiple centres because she had severely compromised lung function, so whatever oxygen would be given during anaesthesia would not effectively reach the lungs. She was eventually referred to us because we were doing the procedure under local anaesthesia," he says. With a monitored anaesthesia specialist present, the Department conducted the procedure successfully and rehabilitated the patient quickly. The other case was of a pregnant woman in her first trimester with severe sciatica who had been suggested termination of pregnancy. Most centres use an X-ray to identify the disc levels but given the patient was pregnant, an ultrasound guided targeting of levels was used. "With the support of the anaesthetic team, we were able to remove the disc fragment successfully. The patient continued with the pregnancy and delivered the baby who is two years old now and doing well," says Dr Karunakaran.

Addressing the Entire Spectrum of Spinal Issues

Spinal problems occur for a variety of reasons, from ageing to wear and tear, trauma-related problems, infections like tuberculosis of the spine, tumours which press down on the spine, and deformities like scoliosis. With the latest technology at their disposal—like 3D printing technology for spine deformity correction—MGM Healthcare's Department of Spine Surgery is well equipped to deal with them.

It's also a team effort with a holistic approach. "After a spine surgeon sees the patient and the diagnosis is done, we collaborate with departments like neurology and physiotherapy to ensure the patient goes through a correct rehab programme. Psychological and nutritional aspects are also addressed," says Dr Karunakaran.

With its well-integrated approach and state-of-the-art technology, the Department of Spine Surgery at MGM Healthcare is able to get patients back on their feet in no time.